

FORREST CAMERANESI

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Remote from Ventura County, CA | forrest@cameranesi.com | 805-729-4846

Full-Stack Web Developer | Extensive Experience | Remote Collaboration Specialist

SUMMARY

Full-stack developer with extensive experience across frontend, backend, infrastructure, and design. Delivered 40+ client projects using modern stacks from PHP and WordPress to Next.js and React. Versatile across both legacy systems and cutting-edge frameworks, with proven ability to maintain traditional LAMP/jQuery applications while building modern React/TypeScript solutions.

Actively leverages AI-assisted development tools (Claude, Copilot, Windsurf, ChatGPT) to accelerate development workflows, reduce time-to-delivery, and rapidly adopt new technologies. Recent projects demonstrate over 3x productivity gains through strategic AI tool integration, including automated Python scripting for complex data processing tasks.

Proven ability to succeed in fully remote environments, with over a decade of experience working with distributed teams across time zones. Equally comfortable working independently or within cross-functional teams. Recognized for strong problem-solving, rapid learning, and clear communication. Open to roles at all levels, including support positions, and motivated by contribution and growth over title. U.S. Citizen – authorized to work in the U.S. without sponsorship, eligible for security clearance.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend: HTML, CSS/SCSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Webpack, jQuery, responsive design

Backend & Server: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Node.js, Ruby on Rails, Python, SQL/MySQL

Infrastructure & Deployment: AWS EC2, traditional LAMP/Apache servers, SSH, Git/GitHub, FTP, deployment workflows, automated testing

CMS & Platforms: WordPress, Divi Builder, WP Engine, Webflow, AEM, Sitecore, EC Cube, Supabase

Development Tools: VS Code, Xcode, npm/yarn, Figma/Adobe XD to HTML/CSS implementation

AI-Assisted Development: Copilot (VS Code and GitHub Desktop), Windsurf (VS Code), Claude and ChatGPT (code generation, debugging, learning new frameworks)

Design: Photoshop, Illustrator

Data Formats & APIs: JSON, REST APIs, EXIF data processing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer | Twisted Rope

Remote from Ojai, CA to Buffalo, NY | 2021 – 2024

- Delivered 30+ client sites and applications, from simple static sites to large-scale Next.js/React SPAs.
- Adapted quickly to diverse stacks (vanilla JS, PHP, React, etc.) based on client needs, working effectively with both modern frameworks and legacy codebases.
- Collaborated in varying roles — support developer, independent project owner, and project lead.
- Contributed to refining internal processes, documentation, and technical approaches.

Art Director | The Monterey Company

Remote from Ojai, CA to Bend, OR | 2012 – 2020

- Designed thousands of emblematic jewelry and promotional products annually.
- Managed workflows for a creative team, balancing client requests with production requirements across many concurrent projects.
- Developed technical artwork for die-cast metals, screen printing, embroidery, and other media.

Software Engineer | CVTech

Santa Barbara, CA | 2011 – 2012

- Built e-commerce features using Ruby on Rails, HTML, SCSS, and JavaScript.
- Created motion graphic ads to support marketing campaigns.

Graphic & Web Designer | Stratus Media Group

Santa Barbara, CA | 2010 – 2011

- Designed and launched three company websites.
- Produced graphics, marketing collateral, and event branding.
- Edited promotional videos and audio content.

Earlier career history includes professional design and development roles since the early 2000s, with further hobby projects predating that.

RECENT PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Automated Photo Gallery Generator (2025 – Present)

Developed a Python script leveraging AI and APIs to auto-generate photo galleries with intelligent metadata extraction. The tool processes EXIF data, integrates OpenStreetMap APIs for location information, and uses both local HuggingFace image classification models and the iNaturalist computer vision API to generate descriptive content. Reduced gallery update workflow from hours of manual work to minutes of automated processing. Demonstrates ability to combine traditional development with modern AI/ML tools to solve real-world problems efficiently.

Continuous Professional Development & Portfolio Modernization (2024 – Present)

Actively enhancing technical capabilities through sustained professional development initiatives. Projects include:

- Converted personal site CSS to modular SASS architecture for improved maintainability
- Migrated JavaScript codebase to modular TypeScript for type safety and better tooling
- Developed PrevHP, a custom lightweight PHP framework incorporating Next.js architectural concepts
- Modernized development workflow: migrated from XAMPP to npm-based dev environment with PHP dev server, concurrent TypeScript/SASS compilation, and proper staging/production deployment pipeline using ssh/git/rsync instead of FTP
- Added comprehensive inline documentation across all codebases
- Redesigned and refactored frontend for responsive performance from mobile to ultrawide viewports
- Integrated modern AI development tools into workflow, achieving over 3x productivity improvements
- Developed proficiency in Python scripting for automation tasks, transforming day-long manual processes into minutes-long automated solutions
- Added comprehensive automated tests (PHPUnit, vitest, pytest)
- Automated building in local development environment and deployment to staging and production environments

Combines deep experience with legacy systems and traditional development practices with enthusiasm for emerging technologies and modern best practices.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Administrator (Volunteer) | The Philosophy Chat (Discord)

2021 – Present

- Senior administrator of the largest online philosophy discussion community, managing 40+ volunteer staff and supporting 30,000+ members.
- Oversaw moderation, staff coordination, and community standards in a distributed remote environment.

EDUCATION

BA Philosophy, UC Santa Barbara – Highest Honors, 3.9 GPA

AA Multimedia, Santa Barbara City College – Honors, 4.0 GPA

PORTFOLIO & PERSONAL PROJECTS

Portfolio: geekofalltrades.org

GitHub: github.com/Pfhorrest

Personal projects: retro game development, fiction writing, philosophy, and photography.